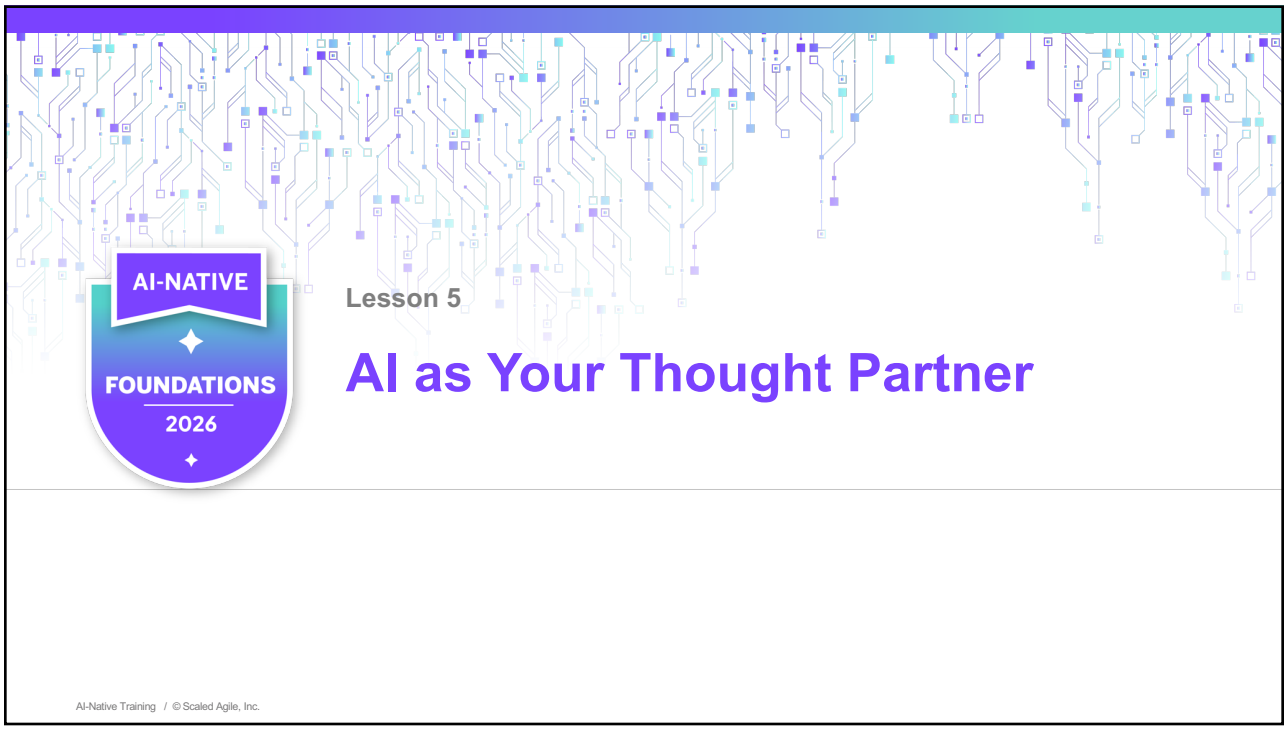


1

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you will:

- Use AI as a thought partner to challenge your assumptions
- Use AI as a thought partner to expand your options
- Use AI as a thought partner to stress-test ideas before you pitch them

2

Class Schedule

Day 1

Lesson 1: EDGE & AI-Native

- 1.1 | The EDGE World
- 1.2 | AI-Native

Lesson 2: AI Technical Literacy

- 2.1 | AI Basics
- 2.2 | Data
- 2.3 | Large Language Models
- 2.4 | Prompting and Safe Use
- 2.5 | Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG)
- 2.6 | AI Agents
- 2.7 | Frontiers In AI

Day 2

Lesson 3: The AI-Native Success Factors

Lesson 4: Improve My Workflow With AI

Lesson 5: AI as Your Thought Partner

Lesson 6: Roadmap to AI-Native

Lesson 7: Tell Your AI-Native Story

3

From Cars to Picnics and Camping

5 min

Class discussion

- **The story**
  - Henry Ford had wood scraps, sawdust, and bark piling up from his automobile lumber mills.
  - He decided to turn the materials into charcoal briquettes by mixing charred wood chips with starch and compressing them.
  - Ford sold the resulting charcoal through his auto dealerships and other retail outlets.
- **Question:** What's different or unique about Henry Ford's thinking here?


GO AFTER THE HUNTING TRADE WITH

FORD CHARCOAL BRIQUET KITS!

BIG DISCOUNTS • QUICK TURNOVER
STEADY DEMAND

● A handy kit for outdoor cooking. Two sizes—one to retail at $1, the other at $2. Consist of portable steel grill, box of Ford Charcoal Briquets, handy container. They'll sell like hot-cakes.

Display these unusual bargains in your window to draw new customers into your store. Big demand now from hunters—steady demand all through the year from skaters, picnickers, campers, tourists. Write today for complete information.

When you write, ask also about the profit opportunities for hardware dealers offered by the *complete* Ford Charcoal Briquet line. This modernized charcoal fuel has more than 100 common uses—year-around sale. Widely used by tinsmiths, plumbers, machine shops, foundries, restaurants, meat packers and householders.

FORD MOTOR COMPANY Ford BY-PRODUCTS DIVISION • DEARBORN, MICHIGAN

OCTOBER 21, 1937 115

4

From Collaborator to Thought Partner

Lesson 4: AI as Collaborator	Lesson 5: AI as Thought Partner
Helps you **do** work faster	Helps you **think** differently
Executes tasks	Challenges assumptions
"Draft this, summarize that"	"What am I missing? What else is possible?"
You improved a workflow	Now stress-test whether it's the right solution

The shift: From "AI does what I ask" to "AI helps me ask better questions"

AI as Your Thought Partner

- **AI sees patterns humans miss** across massive datasets
- **AI doesn't have legacy thinking,** not, "That's how we've always done it"
- **AI can simulate scenarios** at impossible speed/scale
- **AI connects disparate domains—**sees solutions from other industries

Doer Mode (Execution)

- Draft, summarize, rewrite
- Generate steps and checklists
- Produce outputs faster

Thinker Mode (Judgment)

- Challenge assumptions
- Expand options
- Stress-test decisions

Challenges your assumptions

8 min

- **Apply** a Bucket A lens to your Lesson 4 workflow
- **Goal:** confirm you're solving the right problem
- **Capture** your reframed problem statement

A) Challenge / Clarify

- Socratic Questioner
- First Principles Thinker
- Jobs-to-be-Done Theorist
- Inversion Specialist

Expands your options

8 min

- **Apply** a Bucket B lens to push beyond incremental thinking
- **Goal:** Generate options you wouldn't normally consider
- **Capture** one experiment you could run in 2 weeks

B) Expand / Reimagine

- Lateral Thinker
- 10x Moonshot Thinker
- SCAMPER Bot
- Biomimicry Architect
- Blue Ocean Strategist

Stress-tests your ideas

8 min

- **Apply** a Bucket C lens to stress-test your experiment
- **Goal:** Identify what could go wrong and plan for it
- **Capture:** Risk, Mitigation, and Success metric

C) Evaluate / De-risk

- Pre-Mortem Analyst
- Second-Order Thinker
- Steel Man
- Constraints Lover
- Systems Mapper
- Six Thinking Hats

Debrief

5 min

Class discussion:

- Which lens gave you the biggest "aha" moment?
- What assumption did you realize you were making?

Insights and Action

1 min

Reflect

Think about a decision or problem you're currently wrestling with. What assumptions are you making? What options haven't you considered? What could go wrong that you haven't planned for?

Apply

Ask AI: "I'm facing [describe your challenge]. Act as my thought partner. First, challenge my assumptions—what am I taking for granted? Then expand my options—what alternatives haven't I considered? Finally, stress-test my leading idea—what could go wrong?"

Explore

Coming Soon: AI Will Change Our Workflows Big Time—The Future of Work

Transforming Software Development Workflows—Case Study at Amazon

Reimagining Workflows with Agents at the Core—McKinsey, June 2025

Lesson Review

You can:

- Use AI as a thought partner to challenge your assumptions
- Use AI as a thought partner to expand your options
- Use AI as a thought partner to stress-test ideas before you pitch them